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CONFIGURATOR

Version 3.5.2

Product Guide



FRONTISPIECE

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This guide relates to:

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Glossary



Glossary

This glossary provides a definition of terms used in Configurator. Some are general industry terms whilst others have a specific meaning within the context of the Configurator.

Actual component

The configuration route often contains a generic component, which is a 'dummy' item. The dummy item is linked to a range of real or actual components by a common search family. You use the configuration process to select the actual component which is to replace the generic component.

Base item

A special category of item used within Configurator to define item master details which will be used as a base for the generation of **preconfigured item** details during **preconfiguration**.

Bill of materials

The definition of the inputs that are required to make a product. Also known as a Product Structure, Recipe or Formula.

Calculated price

The price calculated by Configurator, as opposed to a fixed price override, for example, in the sales order. The price itself depends on the pricing method, and can include operation costs.

Characteristic

Any of the ten possible attributes definable to a particular **search family**.

Component

Any item that is used in the manufacture of another item.

Configuration route

The special route code reserved for the definition of route details for Configurator **model items** and **configured items**.

Configurator rule

A set of instructions for the inclusion or exclusion of operations or components on a configured route.

Configurator message

Text indicating the existence of an error condition during configuration. This may be due to a rule or quantity range violation.

Configure to order

A business environment in which features and options of a product are tailored to the exact requirements of a customer, and assembled or manufactured to meet a specific customer order. This is a particular form of **Make to order**.

Cost

This is what it costs to produce or purchase an item. Operation costs are held in Production, and are used by Configurator for pricing method 2. Note the difference between 'cost' and 'price' - what the item is to be sold for.

Cost plus

Cost plus margin pricing, or cost plus, rolls up component prices, optionally adds operation costs, and adds on a margin for the parent item. Pricing method 2 on Configurator company profile gives cost plus margin pricing.

Default component

A component selected in route maintenance as the standard **actual component** for a particular **generic component**.

Description table

In Inventory Management, any miscellaneous code and its associated values specified in Descriptions maintenance.

Direct selection

A method of choosing options for a configuration by the direct selection or entry of a component item code.

Discounted unit price

The unit price of an order line or component within a configuration, with any price discounts taken into account.

Feature

An attribute of a configured product, for which alternative **options** are available during configuration.

Formatted Text

Special operation text for **configured items** for which a formal template is specified in Production text maintenance.

Generic Component

A dummy component entered on a configuration route to represent a feature of the configuration. The generic component is replaced by an **actual component** from the same **search family** during the process of configuration.

Inventory source

A user-defined code specified in Inventory descriptions maintenance and attached to an item in Inventory item maintenance. In Configurator, special Inventory source values are reserved for the identification of:

- model items
- base items
- preconfigured items
- order configured items
- generic components

Make to order

A business environment in which a product is assembled or manufactured to meet a specific customer order. **Configure to order** is a particular form of make to order processing.

Message category

A set of **Configurator messages**. Categories are used to aid the search and selection of specific messages.

Message severity

Specifies, for **Configurator messages**, whether the message acts as a warning which can be bypassed (a memo message) or as an error condition which must be addressed by the user (a critical message).

Model item

The item code used in Configurator to define the route which contains all possible operations, standard components and generic components for a particular group of configurable products. The model item route is used as the basis for the definition of route details for individual **preconfigured items**.

The definition of a model is not necessary unless you wish to preconfigure your item.

Operation

A discrete task in the manufacture of a product.

Option

One of a set of alternative components selectable for a specific **feature** of a configuration.

Order configuration

The configuration of a product for a specific customer order line.

Order configured item

This is when all the configuration options are selected in order entry. This kind of item has its own route attached. It is not connected to a model, and preconfiguration is not used.

Ordering method

The method by which an item is sourced for supply to a customer. In Advanced Order Entry, items may be manufactured or purchased to order, in addition to being sourced from existing stock.

Parent item

Any type of manufactured item.

Phantom

Within Production, a phantom item represents a sub-assembly which is being treated as a single item for the purposes of route maintenance. For a true picture of the components used in a phantom, it must be 'exploded', i.e. be represented in full.

Preconfiguration

The optional initial stage in the configuration of a product. Preconfiguration enables you to incorporate selected configuration options into an item before that item is ordered.

Preconfigured item

A preconfigured item is created by taking the base item as a basis and then select certain options. You must first create a model item with an attached route, then a base item in Inventory.

Presentation sequence

The order in which operations and components on a configuration route are presented to the user during the process of configuration. Significantly, this also affects the order in which Configurator rules are applied.

Price

Pricing in Configurator is controlled by the value in the pricing method field on the company profile. This can be:

- 0 - The price is taken to be the list price for the parent item.
- 1 - The price is the total of all components, taken from their list prices.
- 2 - The price is the total of all components and (optionally) operations, plus a mark-up percentage.

Note the difference between 'cost' - what it costs to produce or purchase an item - and 'price' - what the item is to be sold for.

Proactive rule

The automatic application of a **Configurator rule** during the building of a configuration.

Production order

A requirement to manufacture an item, detailing the operations and components to be used. Also referred to as a **works order**. Created automatically for configured and made-to-order lines.

Production sequence

The order in which operations and components on a Production route are to appear for processing on the **production order**.

Prompted selection

A method of choosing **options** for a configuration by the selection of particular item **characteristics**.

Quantity per

The quantity of a component that is required to make the standard lot quantity of its parent item.

Reactive rule

The identification of a **Configurator rule** violation at the review stage of configuration.

Rule action

The action to be performed when a **Configurator rule test** is satisfied.

Rule category

A set of **Configurator rules**. Categories are used to aid the search and selection of specific rules.

Rule section

A particular section of a configured route to which **Configurator rules** are applied.

Rule test

A set of conditions which, when satisfied during configuration, trigger the action of a **Configurator rule**.

Search family

A grouping of items which share certain common attributes or **characteristics**. Search families are used in Configurator to group together related items and to search for items by the entry of characteristic values.

Unprompted selection

A method of choosing **options** for a configuration by the entry of a set of item **characteristics**.

Works order

A requirement to manufacture an item, detailing the operations and components to be used. Also referred to as a **production order**. Created automatically for configured and made-to-order lines.

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